UNIT 1 · TOPIC 6(D)

Chaff Cutters and Forage Harvesters

Syllabus topic: Equipment for harvesting, threshing, mowing, chaff cutting and baling

Chaff cutter

- Hand- or power-operated. Feed rolls meter stalks to flywheel-mounted knives (flywheel type) or to a cylinder-type cutterhead.
- The feed-roll speed and the number of knives set the cut length.
- Power chaff cutters: **2–5 hp**, **0.5–2 t/h**.
- Safety per **IS 7898** (feeding system with a warning device). Chaff cutters commonly cause hand injuries and are covered under the **Dangerous Machines Act**.

Forage harvester (Kepner ch. 15)

1. Cuts the crop (flail or precision-chop type).
2. Chops it — **theoretical length of cut = feed per knife**.
3. Blows the chop into a trailer.